Determinants of context-dependent memory effects in humans

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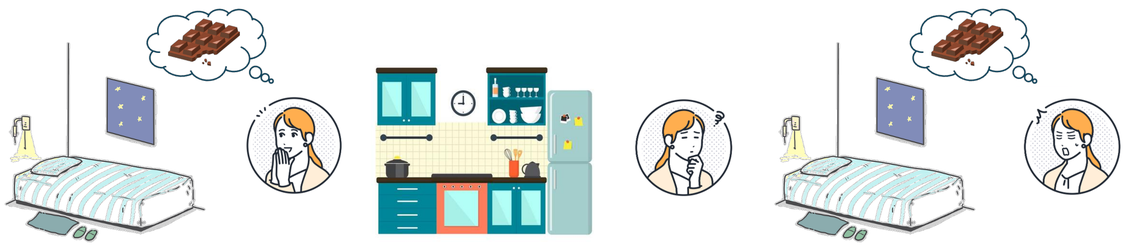
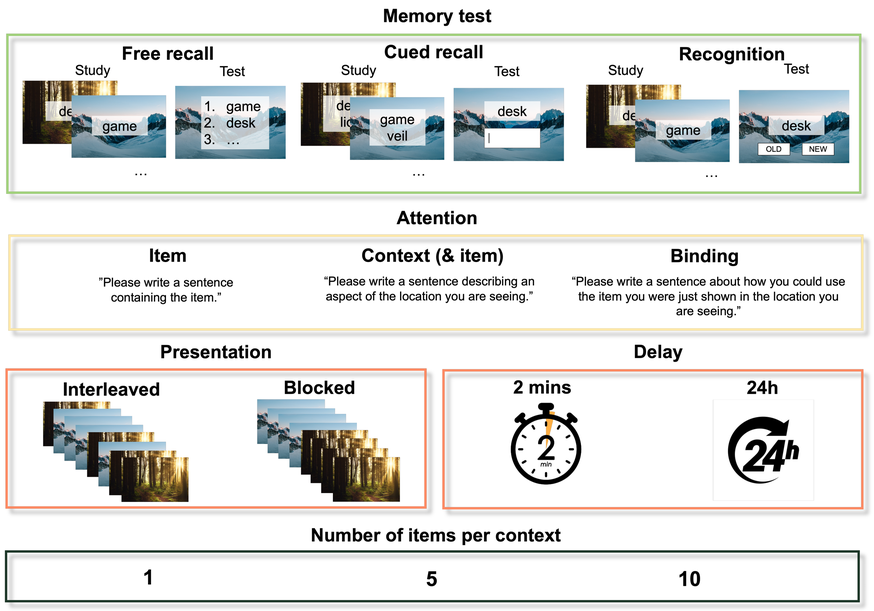
Introduction

Context has long been recognised as a key factor in memory retrieval, yet the ways in which it has been studied as well as the effects it produces are diverse.
We ask:
When and why do context effects emerge?

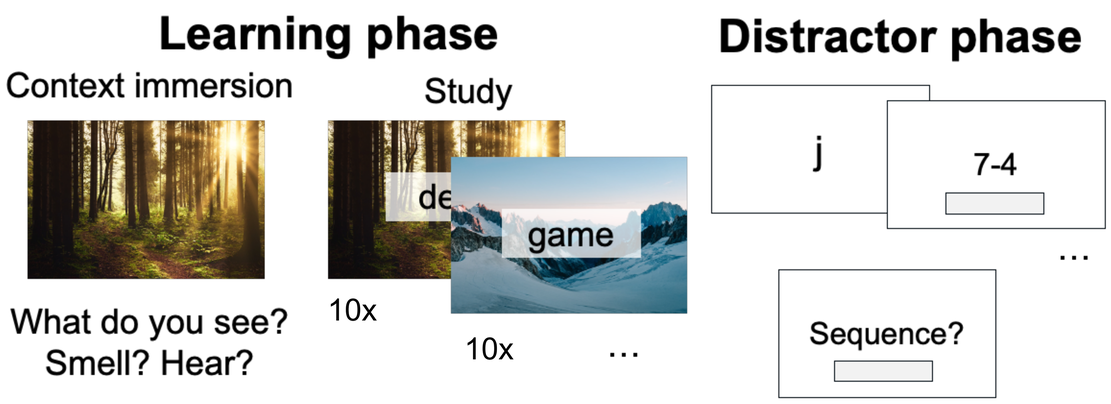


The bigger picture

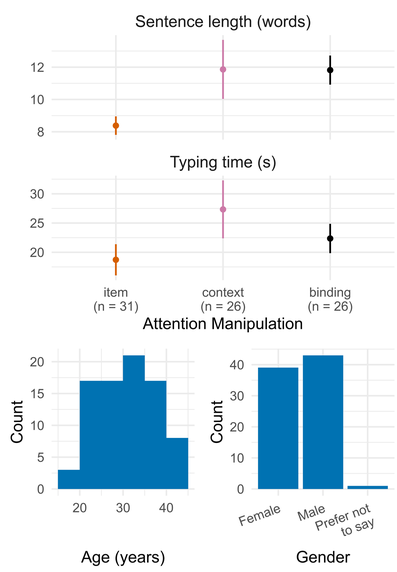


Methods

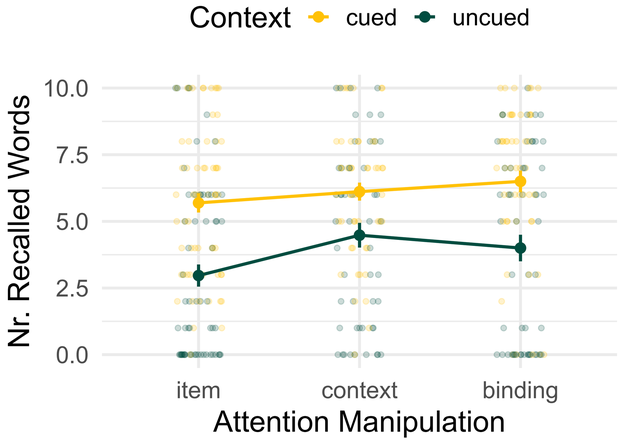
Pilot 1: Focusing on the attention manipulation
Design: Free recall, blocked, 2 mins delay and 10 items per context

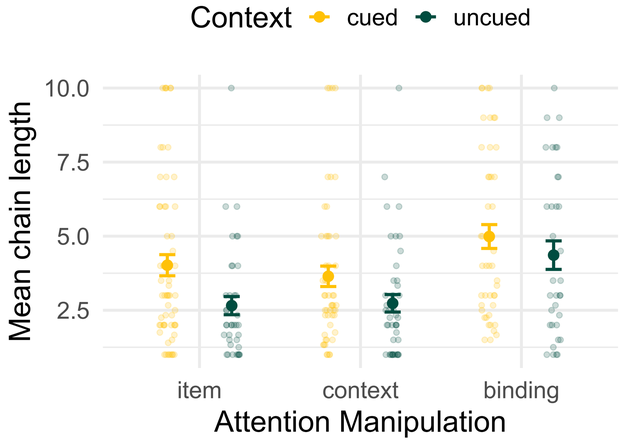


Dependent variable:
Accuracy for same vs different context



Results

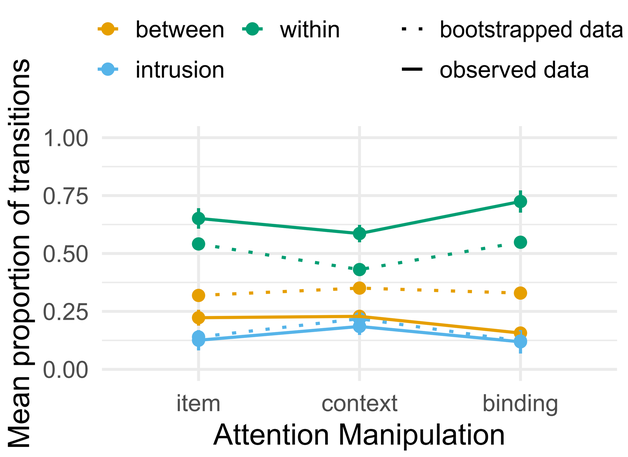


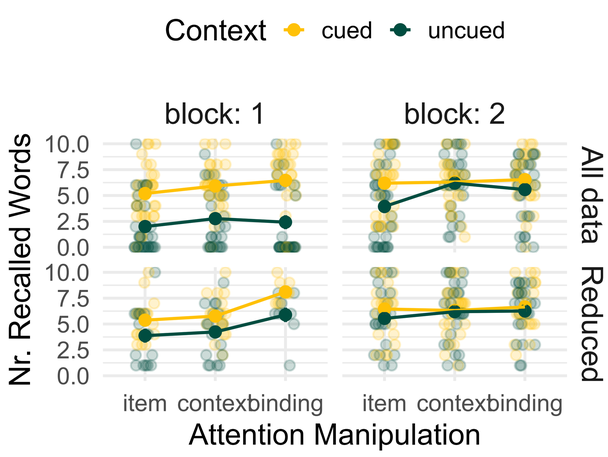


Context effects persist across attention manipulations

Binding at encoding increases context clustering at recall

Open Questions





When does context make remembering easier?

And what is context anyway?